

Legal, Regulatory & Permitting Memo

Permitting path, historical regulatory timing, legal dependencies, and approval sequencing.

Project: Solar Alpha **Location:** Solano County, California (fictional demo site) **Date:** August 14, 2026

Demo note: This document contains intentionally synthetic data and seeded inconsistencies for a one-day hackathon prototype. It is not a real engineering, legal, environmental, investment, or regulatory opinion.

Permitting strategy

The current development plan assumes discretionary approval, environmental review, construction permitting, interconnection approvals, and operating registrations can be completed in parallel. Several critical-path activities, however, have sequential dependencies.

Approval	Base duration	Historical range*	Current target
Local land-use approval	5 months	4-8 months	Nov 2026
Environmental review	8 months	7-13 months	Dec 2026
Grading / building permits	3 months	2-5 months	Feb 2027
Grid interconnection amendment	6 months	5-10 months	Jan 2027
Stormwater authorization	2 months	1-4 months	Feb 2027

*Historical ranges are synthetic demo benchmarks based on a fictional portfolio of comparable projects.

Schedule inconsistency

The integrated project schedule shows limited notice to proceed for grading on October 14, 2026. The environmental assessment expects raptor consultation to complete in December 2026 and the permitting schedule targets environmental review completion in December 2026.

CRITICAL RED FLAG - The construction schedule begins physical work roughly 8 weeks before the stated environmental review / consultation milestone. The project should clarify whether early works are legally separable and permitted.

Historical regulatory behavior

Synthetic portfolio data shows that projects with unresolved habitat consultation at application submittal experienced a median 11-week extension versus projects with surveys closed before filing. Projects with contested access easements experienced a median 7-week permitting delay where agency conditions required proof of legal access.

Material legal dependencies

Issue	Current evidence	Risk
Parcel 14 site control	Unsigned option in title file	High
Heavy-haul easement	Agricultural access language only	Medium-High
Habitat consultation	Open	High
Water supply agreement	50 of 82 acre-feet indicated	High

Issue	Current evidence	Risk
Community benefit commitments	Draft only	Medium

Decision gates

Recommended legal gates before full investment approval: (1) confirm control of Parcel 14 or alternate alignment, (2) reconcile early-works schedule with environmental approvals, (3) secure construction-water pathway, and (4) document heavy-haul access rights.